

Five Mona Lisas

Drawn with TurtlePen, an integer lattice for AI-authored diagrams

One subject, five ways of drawing it: a method diagram, a cartoon, a colouring page, an abstract, and a sculpture in projection.

Every mark is a whole number of quadrants — 5px each — so nothing here is anti-aliased into place. Curves are polylines sampled through control points, which is why the sheets are drawn large: at radius 12 a circle is visibly a staircase, and at radius 60 the same algorithm reads as a curve. Detail is bought with quadrants rather than cleverness.

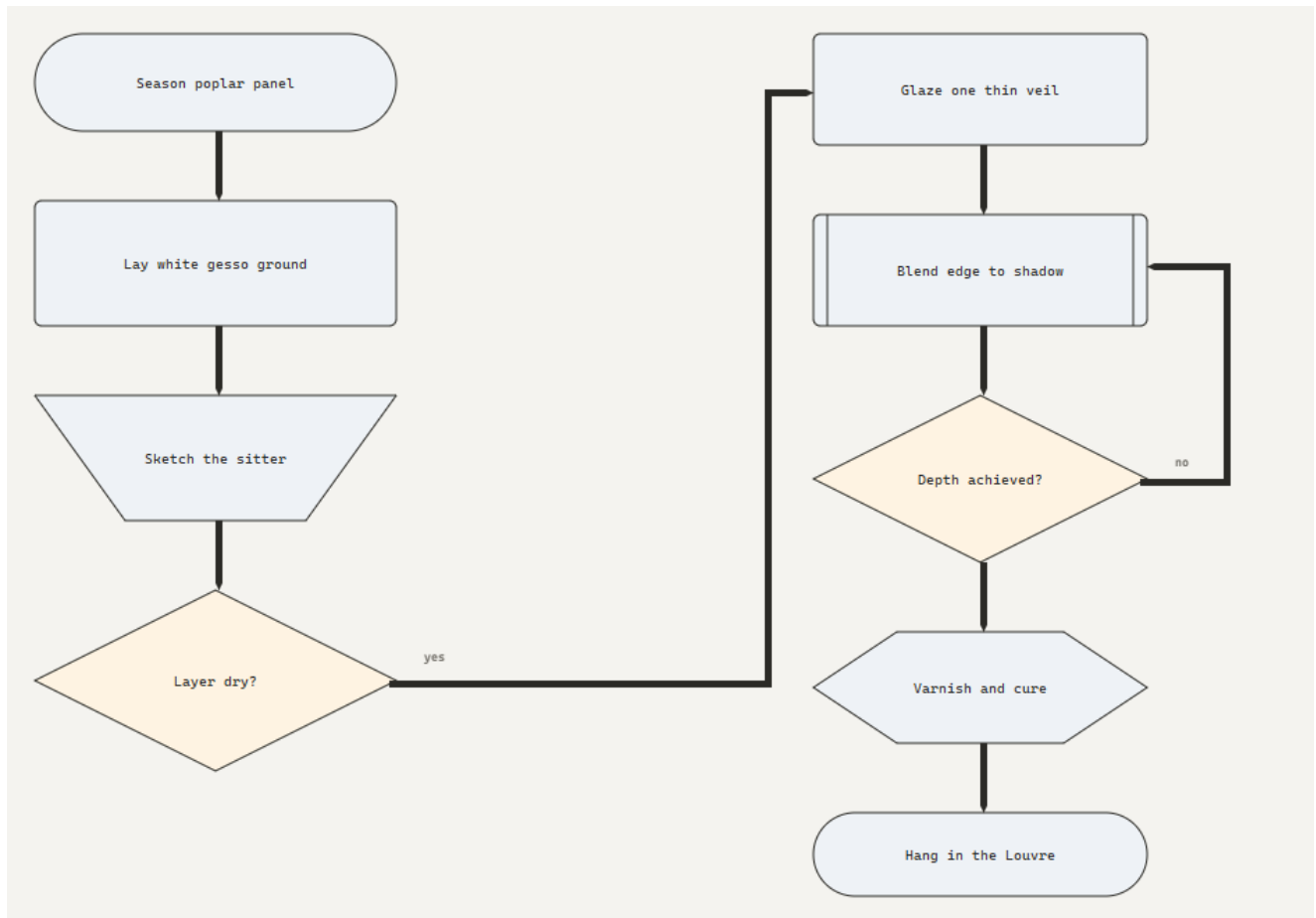
Three engine facts shaped every sheet in the set:

- There is no closed-path fill. A polygon claims its outline and nothing inside, so every filled region here is hatched, and the hatch spacing IS the tone.
- There is no z-buffer. 'Behind' is not a property a mark can hold; it is which page the mark sits on, or else the hidden part simply must not be drawn.
- A clean collision log proves a drawing is undefective, never that it depicts what was asked for. Every sheet below was rendered and looked at, and several were wrong in ways the log had nothing to say about — a horizon drawn straight across her face, a body that stopped in mid-air, a portrait so symmetric it read as a generic face rather than this one.

The SVGs beside this file are the masters. These pages are rasterised from them, because no SVG-to-PDF converter was available on the machine that assembled this.

I — Method

How to paint the Mona Lisa



A flowchart, and the only sheet in the set that is a diagram rather than a picture. Every label is measured against the shape it will sit in, each column is one uniform width so the connectors run straight, and the paths are proposed by the router rather than hand-computed. The two loops — wait for a layer to dry, glaze again until the depth is there — are what separate a painting from a sketch.

II — Cartoon

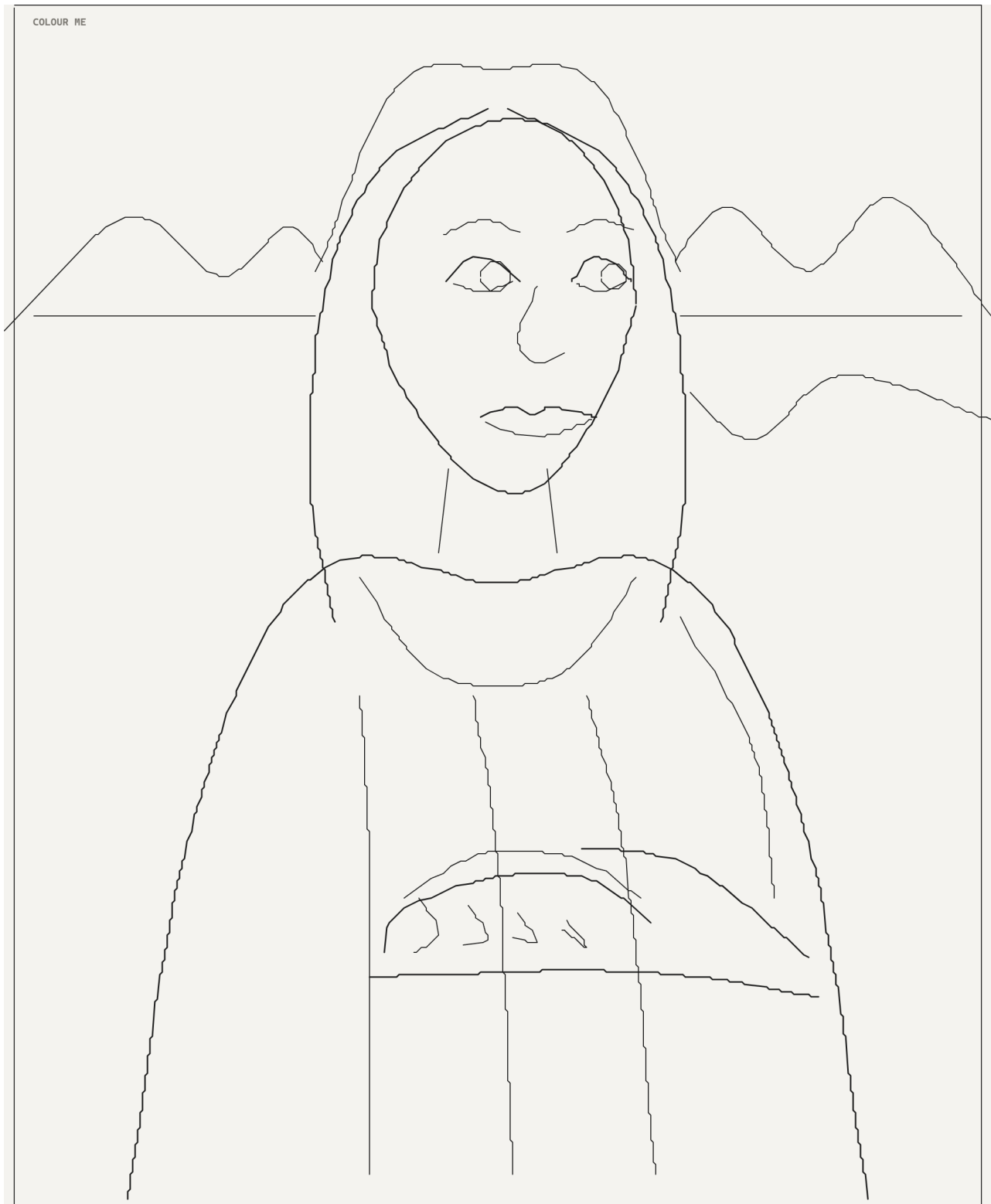
The same sitter, at speed



Heavy contour, exaggerated features, and mass built entirely from hatching, because the lattice has no closed-path fill: a polygon claims its outline and nothing inside, so asking for filled hair returns an outline. The first version of this sheet had no hands at all, which loses the second most recognisable thing in the painting after the smile.

III — Colouring page

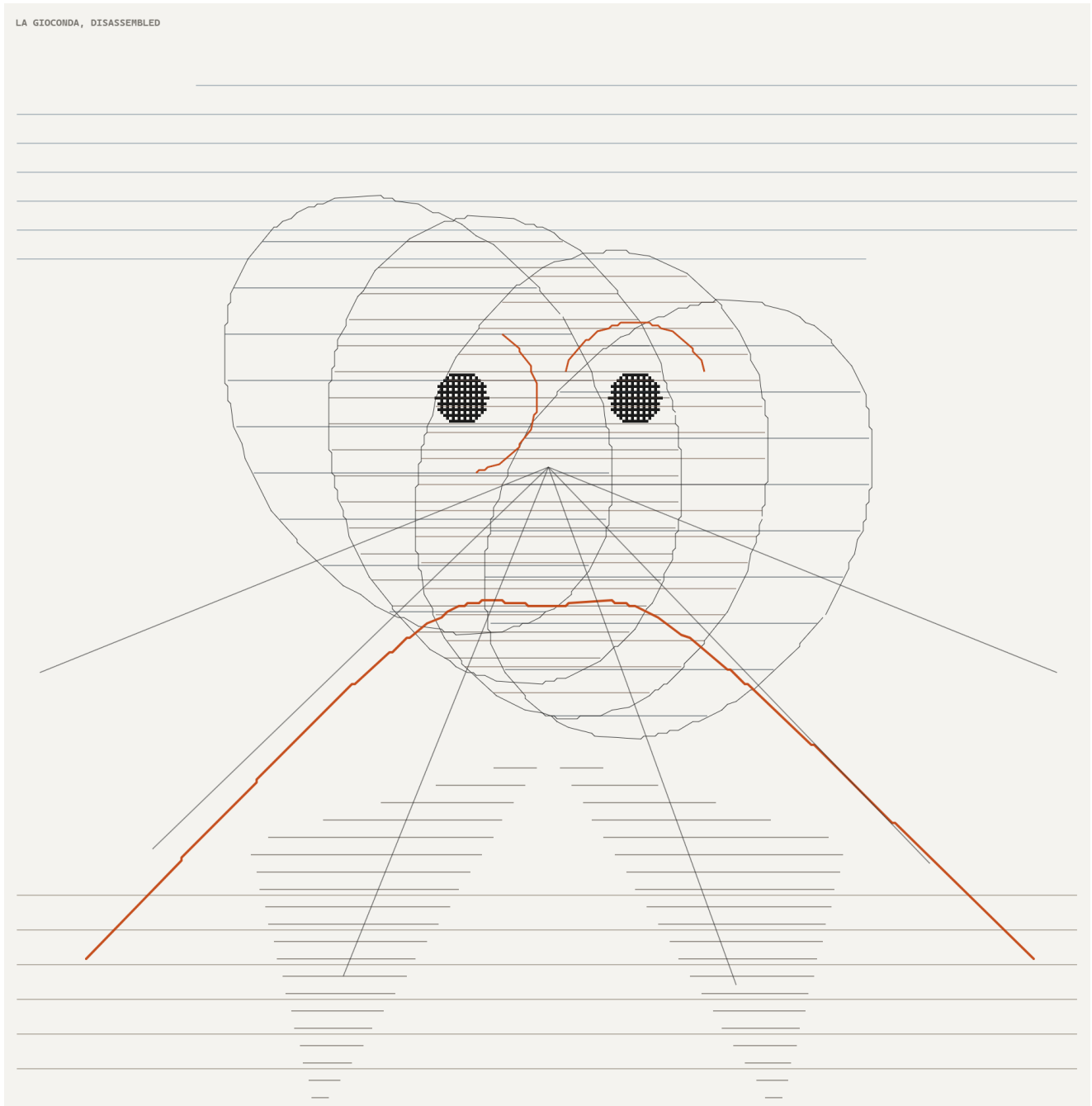
Contour only, nothing filled



The strictest test of the figure: with no tone to carry the form, the outline has to do all of it — which is why every defect in the construction surfaced here first. The eyes were two concentric ovals and read as goggles until they were rebuilt as lids over a ball; the gown was an empty bell until it got folds, a sleeve seam and a chair rail to rest the hands on.

IV — Disassembled

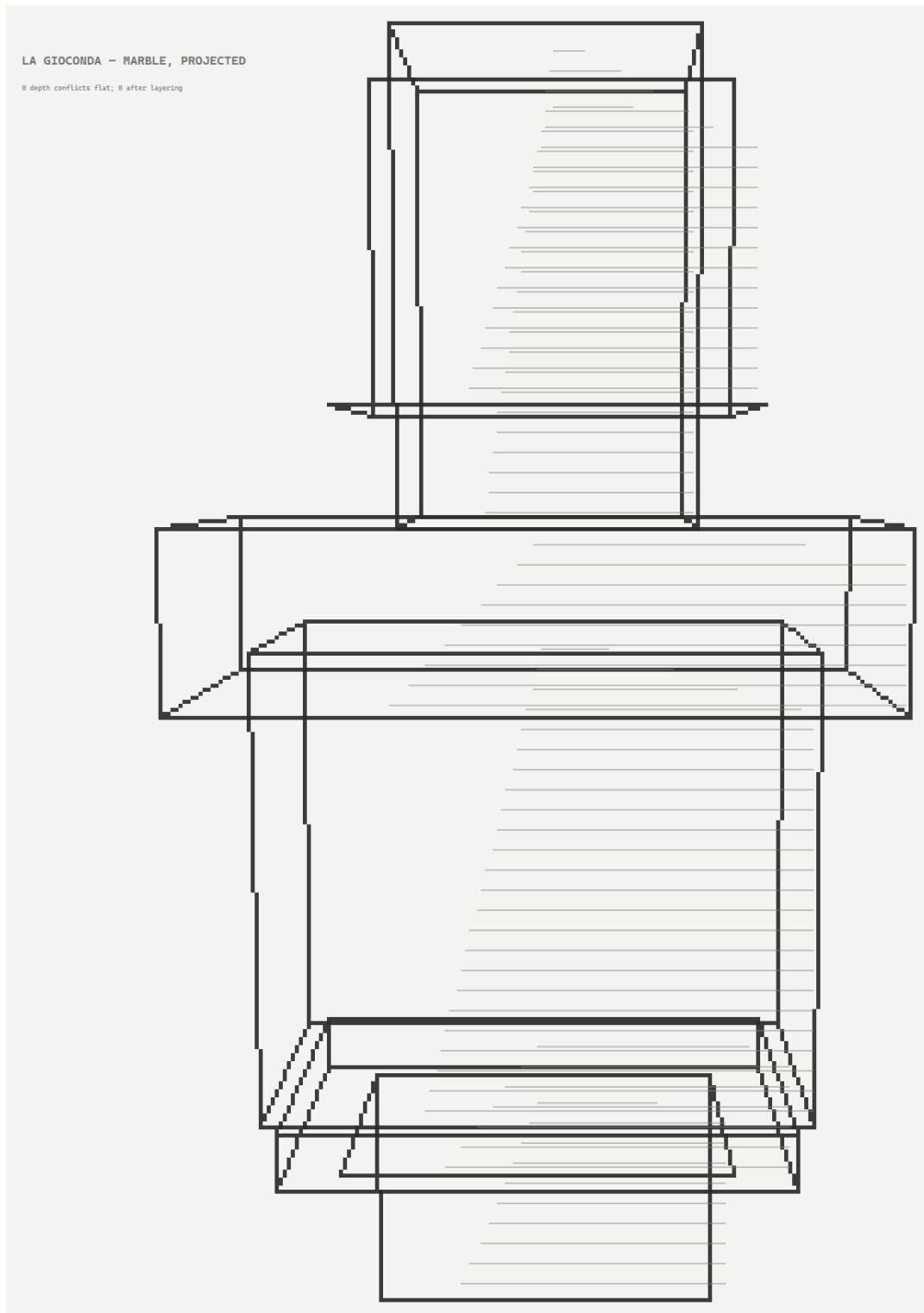
One head, four angles at once



Four ellipses of the same face at four rotations, each hatched at a different spacing, so where they cross the ink accumulates the way overlapping glass does. Density here is spacing rather than opacity: no alpha compositing exists anywhere in the engine, and none is needed. Spread far enough apart to read as four viewpoints — closer together they looked like one slightly blurred head.

V — Marble, projected

Authored in inches, seen through a lens



The only sheet with real three-dimensional geometry behind it. The bust is described in room inches and put through a camera, which brings the depth problem with it: a projection lands on a lattice with no z-buffer, so every block is equally present and the far ones show through the near ones. Each mass sits on its own Z-page, ordered by distance, and the occlusion becomes real.